

HuskiesPaws

How to present the stack: Phone → API → World.

Lead with the product, then name three layers. Judges remember a loop better than a laundry list of libraries.

What to say in one breath

HuskiesPaws is a **phone app**. Shared game rules live in plain JavaScript. A small Node API holds secrets and talks to Grok. Place facts come from Wikipedia; walks come from real routing. If Grok is out of credits, the app still plays.

That is the architecture. Everything else is detail.

The stack, in the order you should tell it

The thing they hold — Expo / React Native (SDK 57)

Expo Go on iPhone. Map, GPS, camera, step counter, on-device speech. Demo Walk for the indoor table. If they ask “native or web?": **native phone app**. The web prototype was dropped.

The rules — core/ (plain JS)

Pets, eggs, ranks, turf, ISS rarity, geo. Same files for the phone and iMessage. Not an LLM deciding the game.

The world — tools, not vibes

- **Wikipedia** for nearby places and the postcard fact.
- **OpenStreetMap / OSRM** for the walking path.
- **wheretheiss.at** for “ISS overhead → rarer hatch.”

Agents only speak what those tools return.

The API — Node (server/)

No extra runtime dependencies. Keys stay here: `XAI_API_KEY`, `ELEVENLABS_API_KEY`. Rate limits and cached Imagine images. The phone never embeds keys.

Voice and pictures (optional, credit-dependent)

- **Grok Voice** for Pip and Fern when the key and credits work.
- **ElevenLabs** for Moss’s stories.
- **Grok Imagine** for postcards and hatch art.
- Fallback: **expo-speech** plus original SVG art.

Say the fallback *before* they hear on-device TTS.

Extra, only if they ask

- **Photon Spectrum** — same squad over iMessage.
- **MapLibre / OpenFreeMap** — garden 3D map, **iOS development build only**; Expo Go is Apple Maps.
- **Supabase / Render** — written; do not claim live unless `/api/health` is green.
- **Cursor** — SpaceX track: built in Agent mode, logged in `CURSOR_LOG.md`.

Do **not** pitch Nessie, background tracking, or a live cloud host unless you have just checked health.

Cheat sheet — how we used each technology

Glance here if a judge names a library. One job per row. Do not invent extra uses.

Technology	How we used it	Where / caveat
Expo / React Native (SDK 57) <code>react-native-maps</code>	The product: map, GPS, camera, steps, sheet UI, Demo Walk. Campus map in Expo Go (Apple Maps on iOS).	<code>mobile/</code> . Expo Go on iPhone. Default judging path.
MapLibre + OpenFreeMap	Garden 3D map on iOS.	Development build only, not Expo Go.
<code>expo-speech</code>	On-device TTS when Grok / ElevenLabs fail or have no credits.	Always the fallback.
<code>expo-haptics</code> , camera, location	Capture feel, indoor postcards, live walks.	Phone permissions.
Plain JS <code>core/</code>	Game truth: agents, eggs, ranks, turf, geo, ISS rarity.	Copied to the app with <code>sync-core</code> . Not an LLM.
Node <code>server/</code>	<code>/api</code> for voice, Imagine, turf, boards. Holds every secret.	No extra runtime deps.
Wikipedia	Nearby places (geosearch) and postcard extracts. Agents may not invent buildings.	Custom User-Agent required.
OSM / OSRM	Walking geometry and remaining distance.	Real paths, including Demo Walk.
<code>wheretheiss.at</code>	Fern only routes from this. Live ISS position; 3× rare-hatch while overhead.	SpaceX-flavored, still a tool.
Grok Voice (xAI)	Spoken memos for Pip and Fern when key + credits work.	Server only. Tests use a fake.
Grok Imagine (xAI)	Postcard / hatch pictures from server-side prompts.	Same: credits or SVG art.
ElevenLabs	Moss's story voice.	Server; otherwise <code>expo-speech</code> .
Original SVG art	Pets, mascot, hatch portraits without Imagine.	Ships in the app.
Photon Spectrum	Same squad roles over iMessage (<code>explore</code> , <code>take me there</code>).	<code>imessage-agent/</code> . Sessions in memory.
Cloudflare tunnel	Expo Go QR on guest Wi-Fi after public ngrok filled up.	<code>npm run tunnel</code> in <code>mobile/</code> .
Cursor	Built the app, deck, and docs in Agent mode (SpaceX track).	Proof: <code>CURSOR_LOG.md</code> , <code>.cursor/rules/</code> .
Supabase Render	Revision-checked turf RPCs in schema. <code>render.yaml</code> blueprint for the API.	Written; not claimed live. Claim live only if <code>/api/health</code> is green.

How to present it at the table (about 2 minutes)

Keep the pitch deck on **slide 4** (Demo Walk on). Hand them the phone.

Time	You do	You say (tech, lightly)
0:00	Title / map	Everyday walks, creature adventure. Navigation = curiosity, not shortest path.
0:15	Squad → Pip → Explore	Pip is a Scout role . Wikipedia finds a real place.
0:35	Postcard → Start the walk	Fern routes you. Flowers are the trail. Demo Walk is simulated.
1:05	Capture / egg	Walking earns the collectible. ISS can make hatches rarer.
1:25	One sentence of architecture	Phone → our API → Wikipedia, maps, optional Grok. Secrets not in the app.
1:40	Cursor	Built in Cursor ; Grok Imagine/Voice when credits allow.
1:50	Close	Hand them the phone. “Ask us anything.”

If Grok is slow or silent: “That’s the fallback. Game still runs.” Then keep moving.

Tracks, in one line each

BigRed / theme	Navigation as “go look,” not “arrive faster.”
SpaceX	Cursor-built + Grok Voice/Imagine in the server (plus ISS data).
Photon	iMessage agent, same core/ roles.
Software	Shared logic, API with validation, tests in core/ , server/ , mobile/ , imessage-agent/ .
Design	Original pets, cream/forest UI, real screenshots on the deck.
Not Capital One	Banking was removed.

Answers they will actually ask

Does the AI make up buildings? No. Scout and story only use Wikipedia. The postcard can show the source link.

Where is the model? Not in the phone. Optional Grok on the server. Game rules are ordinary code.

Why Expo? iPhone demo this weekend without a full App Store build. Camera, location, and speech are Expo modules.

Is it deployed? `render.yaml` is ready. Default is local file storage. Do not say “it’s live on Render” unless health is true.

What did Cursor do? Walk-loop UX, art, Cloudflare tunnel for guest Wi-Fi, deck from real captures, ISS cues — see `CURSOR_LOG.md` if they want proof.

The one diagram to remember

Memorize the three boxes: **Phone** → **API** → **World**. If you only remember one picture from the deck, that is the one.